

Informed Consent Information for Participants Using the Pre-Course Module

Study Title: *Learner Readiness at Course Entry in Joint Planning Process Courses: A Comparative Quantitative Study of an AI-Supported Asynchronous Pre-Course Leveling Module*

Principal Investigator: Mr. Thomas Carr, *Doctoral Candidate, Purdue University Global*

Introduction and Purpose of the Study: You are being invited to participate in a research study conducted as part of a doctoral applied research project through Purdue University Global. The purpose of this study is to examine how learners in Joint Planning Process (JPP) module cohorts differ from learners in comparable prior cohorts on the existing course-entry pre-test. The study also includes a brief learner perception survey to describe how module cohort learners view the AI-supported asynchronous pre-course leveling module as a readiness support before resident instruction begins.

Eligibility Criteria: You may participate in this study if you are at least 18 years old, are part of the approved target training population for a course that includes JPP content, have access to the pre-course leveling module, and are expected to complete the module and course-entry pre-test within the approved data collection window.

Why You Are Being Asked to Participate: You are being asked to participate because you are an eligible learner in the approved target training population and can complete the module and course-entry pre-test before resident instruction. Your participation may help the training center better understand whether the module supports learner readiness at course entry.

Study Procedures: If you choose to participate, you will complete the module as part of this research study before the resident phase begins. The time to complete the module will vary based on participant's interaction with the module and previous experience in JPP. The course-entry pre-test is expected to take approximately 15 minutes, and the voluntary learner perception survey approximately 10 minutes. After completing the module and the existing course-entry pre-test, you will be offered a brief voluntary learner perception survey. The survey will include nine 5-point Likert scale items addressing your perceptions of the module as preparation for resident instruction, the reasonableness of the time required to complete it, and whether you would recommend continuing the module for future learners. You may decline to complete the survey without affecting your participation in the primary pre-test comparison or your relationship with the training center.

Potential Risks and Discomforts: This study is expected to involve minimal risk. Possible risks include mild discomfort from answering survey questions about your preparation or concern about whether responses could affect course standing. Your survey responses and approved research data will not be used to affect course completion, course evaluation, access to instruction, or professional standing.

Although confidentiality protections will be used, there is always a small risk of loss of confidentiality when research data are collected or analyzed. Steps will be taken to reduce this

risk through de-identification, aggregate reporting, secure storage, and limited access to approved research data.

Potential Benefits of Participation: You may not receive a direct personal benefit from participating in this study. The study may benefit the training center by providing local evidence about learner readiness at course entry and the usefulness of the module as a readiness support. The findings may help course leadership make informed decisions about improving pre-course preparation and preserving resident instructional time for coached application, guided practice, and feedback.

Confidentiality and Data Protection: Research data will be handled according to Purdue Global Institutional Review Board (IRB) requirements, site policies, and the approved data management plan. Approved training center personnel will remove direct identifiers and replace them with study identifiers before the researcher receives the research dataset. The researcher will receive only the de-identified fields approved by the training center and the IRB. The research site, participants, instructors, and units will be described using pseudonyms or generic labels in the final report.

Data will be stored in password-protected or otherwise approved secure locations. Only approved individuals will have access to identifiable or protected data, if such access is required. Results will be reported in aggregate form. Individual learners will not be named in the study report. Research data will be retained and destroyed according to the approved IRB application, university requirements, and applicable site data protection rules.

Compensation: There is no compensation for participating in this study.

Voluntary Participation and Right to Withdraw: Your participation in this research study is voluntary. The module is not part of normal course preparation, and choosing not to participate will not affect your course standing, course completion, evaluation, access to required instruction, or relationship with the training center, Purdue University Global, or the researcher. You may withdraw from the research study at any time without penalty or consequence.

If you choose to withdraw, no new survey responses will be collected from you for the study. Data already de-identified or included in aggregate analysis may not be removable if they can no longer be linked to you.

Maintaining Honesty & Research Integrity: Please answer survey items honestly based on your own experience with the module and your sense of preparedness before resident instruction. There are no right or wrong answers on the learner perception survey.

The researcher will maintain research integrity by accurately representing the approved data, avoiding fabrication or falsification, minimizing bias in analysis and reporting, and interpreting findings within the limits of the nonexperimental study design.

Contact Information:

If you have questions about this study, you may contact:

Researcher: Mr. Thomas Carr
Email: thomascarr@student.purdueglobal.edu

Faculty/Research Project Chair: Dr. Lina Rawlings
Email: lina.rawlings@purdueglobal.edu

For questions about your rights as a research participant or concerns about the study, you may contact:

Purdue Global Institutional Review Board
Email: pgirb@purdueglobal.edu

Continuing with the Module Indicates Consent: By continuing the module, you are indicating that you have read this informed consent information, understand the purpose and procedures of the study, are at least 18 years old, and voluntarily agree to participate in the research. You may stop participation in the research at any time without penalty or consequence.